

How Sweet and Awesome Is the Place

- 1 How sweet and awesome is the place
with Christ within the doors,
while everlasting love displays
the choicest of her stores.
- 2 While all our hearts and all our songs
join to admire the feast,
each of us cries, with thankful tongue,
“Lord, why was I a guest?”
- 3 “Why was I made to hear thy voice,
and enter while there’s room,
when thousands make a wretched choice,
and rather starve than come?”
- 4 ’Twas the same love that spread the feast
that sweetly drew us in;
else we had still refused to taste,
and perished in our sin.
- 5 Pity the nations, O our God,
constrain the earth to come;
send thy victorious Word abroad,
and bring the strangers home.
- 6 We long to see thy churches full,
that all the chosen race
may, with one voice and heart and soul,
sing thy redeeming grace.

Words: Isaac Watts, 1707; alt.

Music: Irish melody; arr. Charles V. Stanford, 1906

Tune: ST. COLUMBA · CM · Scripture: Luke 14:16

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